dangerous, but they also explicitly draw on similar strands of argument. Both are based on an understanding of Islam as a religion that is intrinsically violent, and both use particular examples like ISIS to illustrate this universal claim. There are, of course, key differences: arguments about the vulnerability of Buddhism, and references to instances of Muslims denigrating Buddhism and concerns about demography are common in Myanmar, where they are not in the US. But in both cases, the use of global arguments about Muslims elsewhere is an important part of reinforcing a sense of general threat from Muslims at home. This is a parallel, but in Myanmar it also appears to be a productive interrelationship: the strand of argument about Islam in the world that is used to bolster a larger narrative of Muslim threat in Myanmar explicitly draws on discourses that have grown into global prominence as a part of the "War on Terror". These arguments about Islamic extremism and terrorism are common in the US, as I have discussed, but also exceed individual Western countries and are visible elsewhere, including in Myanmar's regional neighbours such as Sri Lanka, India, and Thailand.

In Myanmar, these arguments not only parallel narratives constructed elsewhere, they explicitly draw on and make use of these discourses as semiotic material. The relationships between these materials — produced elsewhere and used in Myanmar — are most clearly seen on social media. Social media technologies have changed rapidly over the last three years: pre-publication censorship has ended and the percentage of the population with a mobile phone and access to the internet has expanded from seven to forty-five per cent (Myanmar Centre for Responsible Business 2015). In this changing media environment, Facebook has come to be one of the most popular platforms in the country, used by media companies and government officials to publish stories and make official statements — and by people in Myanmar who are actively seeking to collect ideas and pieces of information and use them to construct narratives about the world (Schissler 2016). In online spaces, the circulation of such discourses leaves digital trails that can be compared and traced. People in Myanmar posting on Facebook can evidence news articles, websites, memes, or other content generated by people elsewhere in the world. Such cases illustrate moments when discourses about Islam in the US and other places are not only paralleled in Myanmar, but actively used and adapted.

Such uses became most apparent to me in April 2014, as I observed a contest unfold over the nature of free speech and inter-religious harmony.